

5. PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

5.1 Introduction

The Project Planning Phase converts the project requirements and design into an organized implementation plan.

The project is divided into multiple phases so that each component can be configured and validated before moving to the next stage.

5.2 Project Implementation Plan

Phase 1: Requirement Analysis and Planning

Activities:

- Understand the business problem.
 - Identify stakeholders.
 - Define business objectives.
 - Define functional scope.
 - Identify required ServiceNow modules.
 - Prepare the execution roadmap.
-

Phase 2: Create New Service and Service Offering

Activities:

- Define the required service.
 - Configure the service offering.
 - Associate relevant service information.
 - Prepare the service structure for incident management.
-

Phase 3: Incident Record Creation

Activities:

- Open the Service Operations Workspace.
 - Create an incident record.
 - Enter caller and incident information.
 - Provide short description and detailed description.
 - Save the incident.
 - Verify that the incident number is generated.
-

Phase 4: Incident Classification

Activities:

- Select Category.
 - Select Subcategory.
 - Select Service.
 - Select Configuration Item.
 - Set Impact.
 - Set Urgency.
 - Verify Priority.
 - Validate classification information.
-

Phase 5: Knowledge Integration

Activities:

- Open Agent Assist / Knowledge functionality.
 - Search for relevant knowledge.
 - Review available knowledge articles.
 - Identify possible solutions.
 - Use knowledge information during incident investigation.
 - Validate the relationship between incident handling and Knowledge Management.
-

Phase 6: Reassignment and Escalation

Activities:

- Review the incident.
- Identify whether the Service Desk can resolve the issue.
- Reassign the incident when required.
- Select the appropriate Level 2 support group.

- Assign the incident to the responsible technician.
 - Verify ownership and assignment information.
-

Phase 7: Incident Tracking by Level 2

Activities:

- Level 2 technician reviews the incident.
 - Investigates the reported problem.
 - Adds work notes.
 - Updates incident status.
 - Reviews related information.
 - Performs troubleshooting.
 - Determines the appropriate resolution approach.
-

Phase 8: Emergency Change Request Creation

Activities:

- Determine whether an IT change is required.
 - Create an Emergency Change Request from the incident.
 - Provide change details.
 - Associate the change with the incident.
 - Validate the relationship between Incident and Change records.
-

Phase 9: Child Incident Creation

Activities:

- Identify related or recurring issues.
 - Create a child incident.
 - Link the child incident to the parent incident.
 - Track child incidents separately.
 - Validate the parent-child relationship.
-

Phase 10: Incident Resolution

Activities:

- Identify the root cause or incident cause.
 - Document resolution details.
 - Update the incident state.
 - Complete required resolution fields.
 - Validate that the incident can proceed toward closure.
-

Phase 11: Knowledge Creation

Activities:

- Identify useful resolution information.
 - Create a Knowledge Article based on the resolved incident.
 - Add appropriate article information.
 - Review and validate the knowledge content.
 - Make the knowledge available for future support activities according to the configured process.
-

Phase 12: Final Validation

Activities:

- Verify incident creation.
 - Verify classification.
 - Verify assignment.
 - Verify escalation.
 - Verify knowledge integration.
 - Verify change integration.
 - Verify child incident relationships.
 - Verify resolution information.
 - Verify knowledge creation.
 - Verify SLA and related record information.
-

Phase 13: Testing and Deployment Validation

Testing should cover the complete incident lifecycle.

Test cases include:

- Incident creation test

- Classification test
 - Priority test
 - Assignment test
 - Reassignment test
 - Level 2 escalation test
 - Knowledge search test
 - Emergency change creation test
 - Child incident creation test
 - Resolution test
 - Knowledge article creation test
 - SLA validation test
 - Related record validation test
-

Phase 14: Conclusion

The final stage evaluates whether the configured Incident Management process satisfies the defined requirements.

The project should demonstrate that an incident can be handled through a structured lifecycle from creation to resolution while maintaining appropriate relationships with Knowledge Management and Change Management.